

New JETRO Regional and Analysis Report Announcement (September 10, 2026 Issue)

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Thank you for using JETRO Members Service.

We are pleased to deliver new information on JETRO's regional and analysis reports, which provide unique perspectives on political and economic trends in major countries and regions worldwide. We hope you will find these reports useful.

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[Special Feature] Innovative Future of Japanese Companies Created with Highly Skilled Foreign Talent

The number of foreign workers in Japan continues to increase year after year, surpassing 2 million for the first time as of the end of October 2023. Among these, the increase in "residency status in specialized and technical fields," including highly skilled foreign talent, is most notable. Behind the growth in employment lies expectations that go beyond merely filling labor shortages. Highly skilled foreign workers have high potential to bring positive effects to companies by driving innovation, supporting overseas expansion, and improving existing services. This special feature traces actual examples of highly skilled foreign talent through interviews with companies that employ them.

[Special Feature] Turbulent Middle East Situation: Impact and Outlook for Middle Eastern Countries

Due to the destabilization of the Middle East situation, the business environment for companies operating in the region has undergone significant changes. This special feature examines the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region, tracking recent trends in logistics and trade, various industries, and corporate initiatives, while also investigating and analyzing government responses and economic policies according to the situation. Through these analyses, we comprehensively clarify geopolitical risks and new market opportunities in the MENA region, and introduce a wide range of information to support Japanese companies' future business in the Middle East.

[Special Feature] Business Cases in Africa

In Africa, diverse business opportunities are emerging not only for large companies with networks and financial resources, but also for startups with cutting-edge technology and small and medium-sized enterprises in various fields. Additionally, diverse approaches are possible for each country, such as collaboration with established third-country companies or local enterprises. This special feature has been introducing specific African businesses,

including movements before and after the 9th Tokyo International Conference on African Development (TICAD9) in fiscal years 2024 and 2025. In fiscal year 2026, with an eye toward TICAD10, we will broadly cover business cases of Japanese companies and local enterprises primarily through company interviews, exploring new business opportunities, collaboration possibilities, and hints for business expansion that emerge locally.

[Asia • India]

Business Opportunities for Japanese Life Insurance Companies: ICICI Prudential on India's Life Insurance Market

India's life insurance market has long been dominated by the state-owned Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC). However, the market structure has changed significantly since the establishment of the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) in 2000 and the entry of private companies, including foreign firms. Over the past decade, the market share of private life insurance companies has expanded approximately 1.6 times, from 27.4% in fiscal year 2015 (April 2015 - March 2016) to 44.8% in fiscal year 2024, transitioning from an era of LIC dominance to one of intense competition. This article presents interviews conducted with executives from ICICI Prudential Life Insurance, a major private life insurance company in India, to discuss the characteristics of India's insurance market from a local company perspective and business opportunities for Japanese life insurance companies.

[Asia • Thailand] "Asia's Detroit" at a Critical Juncture: Trends in Thailand's Automobile Industry

While Thailand's automobile market shows signs of recovery, its...